

Collision Repair Information Bulletin

FOR THE COLLISION REPAIR PROFESSIONAL

TITLE:	Frame Repair & Component Replacement	2020-193
SECTION:	Structural	Page 1 of 1
APPLICABLE VEHICLES:	All Toyota & Lexus	
DATE:	February 2020	

Frame Component - Service Parts

During a collision, full frame components may be damaged and require replacement. Frame components may be replaced individually when New Toyota Genuine OEM service parts are available. However, do not presume that if a component is available that there are published replacement procedures. In the case where specifications/procedures are not available, the decision to replace individual components is at the discretion and good judgment of the collision repair professionals taking responsibility for performing that type of repair.

Frame Repair Precautions

Sectioning of frames is not an approved repair procedure. Sectioning is defined as the partial replacement of components at locations other than an original seam or joint. When a frame is determined to be repairable by the replacement of individual components, installation should be at factory seams or joints and replicate original factory attachment methods with corrosion protection.

Since all Toyota and Lexus frames are made from High Strength Steel (HSS); Toyota does not approve of any heating method to stress relieve HSS during the repair process. Overheating HSS degrades the integrity, durability, and corrosion resistance of a frame.

'Cold straightening', defined as pulling, pushing and hammering, are the only approved methods to stress relieve collision damage. If a frame cannot be restored to original contour and dimensions by cold straightening during the repair process, it should be replaced.

Salvage Frame Components

The use of salvage frame components is not an approved repair procedure. Because there is no way to verify the condition or correct application of salvage components, only new Toyota Genuine OEM service parts are approved for frame repair.

For more information on this and other important collision repair topics visit the Toyota Technical Information System (TIS) www.techinfo.toyota.com